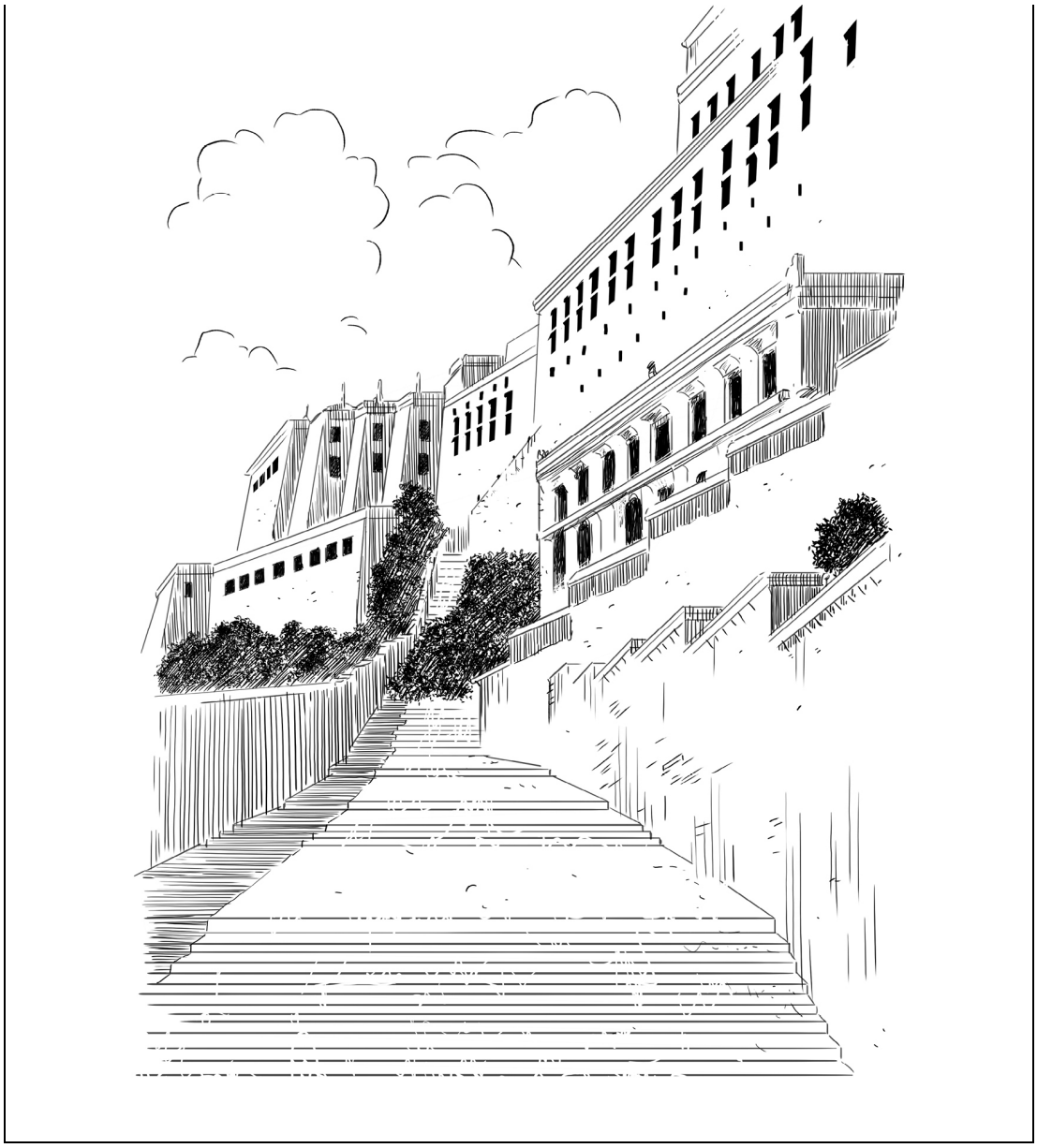


The Tsering family was changing. The Dalai Lama’s brother Norbu was a busy monk, Lobsang and Gyalo were off at school, and his sister Dolma had moved back in with the family. His parents had another daughter, Jetsun Pema, and another son, Tendzin Choegyal. His father often came to the palace for morning tea, so the Dalai Lama saw him often. But sadly, in 1947, when he was about twelve years old, his father died. According to custom, the family prayed for forty-nine days and gave away everything that belonged to him.